

house, but needed to save up for the down payment first. Now with this wedding debt to pay, their dream of a house would have to be postponed.

The stress of the debt started to affect their relationship. Cliff had to negotiate payment arrangements with many of the vendors, which was humiliating to him. He ended up working overtime to pay for the debt. It seemed to Jennifer that he spent more and more time away from home. In fact, Cliff was so mad at the circumstances caused because of the wedding debt that after only a year their marriage fell apart. The irony was that Jennifer had wanted the perfect wedding so badly that she had failed to consider the most important ingredient of a successful marriage, communication.

Problems occur when communication is lacking. One person's statement may be interpreted in a way that was not the intent:

<u>Statement</u>	<u>Interpretation</u>
It's my money, I'll buy anything I please.	Your views are unimportant.
Don't worry; I'll take care of you.	You can't take care of yourself.
I don't want to talk about it.	It's none of your business.
All I do for you and this is the thanks I get.	You are ungrateful.

Statements like, "I don't want to talk about it," are counter-productive. Since relationships are a partnership, the couple must learn to make financial decisions in concert and not independently. Arguments are sure to arise when unilateral decisions, such as how to spend the income tax refund or the company bonus, are made. If the wife arrives home to discover a motorcycle in the driveway instead of that long promised vacation, there is sure to be trouble.

